

GGTOW

NO, YOU DID NOT READ THAT WRONG.

I didn't accidentally put a G instead of an M in the title. While MGTOW has been a relatively new phenomenon, GGTOW or Geeks Going Their Own Way has been a phenomenon ever since the first geek came across an intriguing object and felt that they could make it better or perhaps take advantage in some way. We've had plenty of examples in the past where folks have found ways to hack the telephonic system with phreaking or using blades to make foxhole radios during World War II. The DIY scene has always been limited to a few individuals who not only had the know-how but also the means to take something and improve it. With time, this niche scene has grown, and we now have folks from all age groups tinkering with their daily drivers. Almost everyone who's interested to know more about their phones understands the concept of rooting and playing around with the innards of the OS.

Taking that one step ahead is the concept of creating custom ROMs. Since Android started with the aim of being completely open, there have been more custom flavours of Android than there are phone manufacturers and OEMs. Which is exactly why we went on to bringing you a FastTrack that's all about customising Android even further. Think of Android as your Windows PC, a lot of the customisation options which the PC provides isn't present in Android in its default state. You can bring all those customisation options into your phone with a custom Android version. Don't like the UI elements? Change it up. Don't like the default audio signature? Change it up. Does your phone run hotter than what

you feel it should? Underclock your phone. Most online tutorials only cover the simplistic aspect of theming your phone. Being Digit readers, we believe you deserve much more and hopefully, the FastTrack lives up to your expectations.

GGTOW certainly has its positive attributes wherein you have a lot more people working in their own siloes coming up with features that mainstream manufacturers may deem 'unprofitable'. So the innovation aspect is very strong with the GGTOW movement. Unfortunately, there's the problem of fragmentation which is made worse as more branches of the same OS start popping up. However, if you liken this phenomenon to that of natural selection that we see all around us, then we know where this is all heading. Each branch or fragment that arises is like a gene mutation, and if it propagates well enough, you end up creating a new species that has adapted to the changes in its environment. The modding scene is exactly that. Mods of any form are created because there's a need that hasn't been met. And if the mod becomes popular enough, it gets adopted and incorporated into the ecosystem. What we get at the end is a stronger and better product.

We understand the reach and the influence that we have on the Indian geek community which is why we've dedicated an entire magazine along with its components towards this scene. **d**



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Let me know your thoughts on this column at:
@mithun_mohandas |
mithun@digit.in

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